Read Words in Context

READ!

The Farmer and the Wise Woman



Once upon a time, there was a farmer who could not **concentrate** because his house was so noisy. He asked many people what to do. They told him to **consult** the Wise Woman to ask her advice.

"Since so many people have **referred** me to her, I'm sure she can help," he thought, as he set out for her house.

"I have a problem," the farmer said when he met the Wise Woman. "I am annoyed and **irritated** because my house is very small and we have so many noisy children."

The Wise Woman said, "**Coax** your horse to come inside your house by talking to it in a pleasant and gentle way." The farmer thought this an odd suggestion, but he did as he was told.

The next day, the farmer returned to the Wise Woman. He was very angry. "I **reject** your advice! It didn't help me!" he yelled. "I can't **manage** to get anything done. The children are as noisy as ever, and now the horse **topples** the furniture and dishes. It makes them fall over and break."

The Wise Woman said, "Load your brother's cows on your truck and **transport** them to your house. Bring them inside."

Even though he was angry, the farmer decided to do as he was told. This **boosted** the noise to an even higher level! The farmer **devoted** all day to chasing the animals and his children. The animals **assembled** all over the house, gathering in groups. After weeks of this, the farmer grew very tired. He **weakened** and lay down to rest.

When he was rested, he went back to the Wise Woman's house. "Now," she advised, "take all the animals outside." The farmer did as she said. A day later, he came back.

"I **apologize**," he said. "I am sorry. My house is back to normal and now it seems peaceful. You have **revealed** to me a truth about life. People should learn to be content with their lives."

Vocabulary Words

apologize	**manage**
assemble	**refer**
boost	**reject**
coax	**reveal**
concentrate	**topple**
consult	**transport**
devote	**weaken**
irritate	

Word Learning Tip!

A **verb** is a word that shows actions or feelings. Often, a verb comes right after a noun or pronoun. Sometimes a verb ends in *-s, -ed,* or *-ing*. A verb may have a helping word in front of it such as *may, can, will, shall, must, could,* or *would*. You can use these clues to learn unknown words.

Vocabulary Building Strategy

Use Context Clues Many times, you can determine the meaning of a verb you don't know by using context clues. The words and sentences surrounding the unfamiliar verb can help you understand what it means.

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Connect Words and Meanings

apologize	**coax**	**devote**	**refer**	**transport**
assemble	**concentrate**	**irritate**	**reject**	**reveal**
boost	**consult**	**manage**	**topple**	**weaken**

Directions Write the letter of the correct definition in the space before the word. You may use the glossary to help you.

_____ **1.** irritate — **A.** to control or direct

_____ **2.** weaken — **B.** to lift or increase

_____ **3.** concentrate — **C.** to put together or gather in groups

_____ **4.** transport — **D.** to annoy or bother

_____ **5.** assemble — **E.** to focus on something

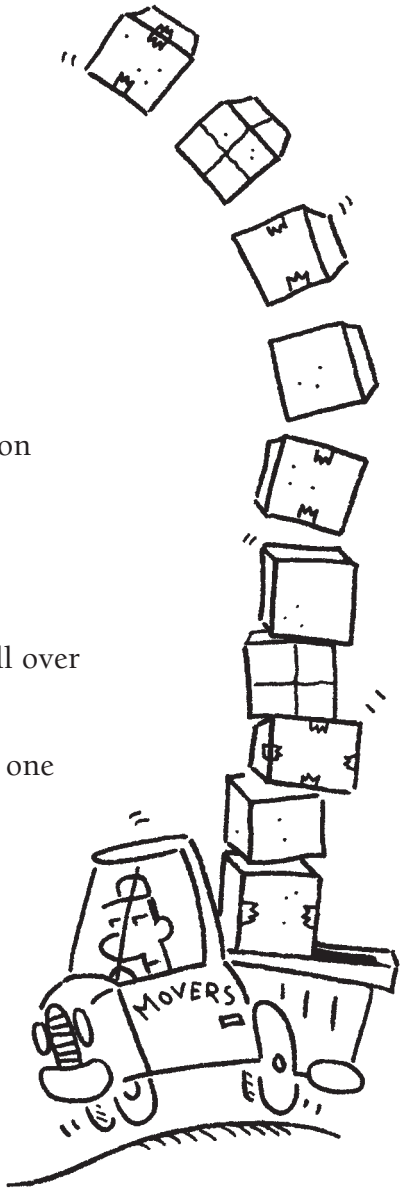
_____ **6.** boost — **F.** to tell someone to go to a certain person or place for help or information

_____ **7.** refer — **G.** to lose strength

_____ **8.** manage — **H.** to fall over or to make something fall over

_____ **9.** consult — **I.** to move someone or something from one place to another

_____ **10.** topple — **J.** to go to another person or resource for information and advice



Continued on next page

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Connect More Words and Meanings

apologize	**coax**	**devote**	**refer**	**transport**
assemble	**concentrate**	**irritate**	**reject**	**reveal**
boost	**consult**	**manage**	**topple**	**weaken**

Directions Read each definition below. Circle the letter of the word that matches.

11. to say you are sorry about something
A. apologize **B.** consult **C.** devote **D.** weaken

12. to refuse to accept something
A irritate **B.** reveal **C.** reject **D.** assemble

13. to persuade someone by asking in a pleasant and easy way; to urge
A. boost **B.** coax **C.** transport **D.** manage

14. to give time and effort to some purpose
A. devote **B.** topple **C.** reject **D.** refer

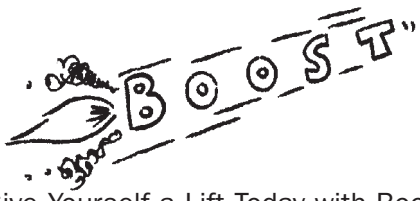
15. to show or make known; to uncover
A. concentrate **B.** apologize **C.** reveal **D.** coax

16. to annoy or bother
A. coax **B.** irritate **C.** refer **D.** reject

17. to make less strong
A. reveal **B.** apologize **C.** boost **D.** weaken

18. to bring together as a group
A. consult **B.** manage **C.** assemble **D.** devote

Create a Billboard Choose three of your vocabulary words. Write each verb in a creative way so that the word looks like its meaning. For example, you might write *boost* like the sample on the right to show that it means to lift up. Then add words to create a billboard slogan.



Give Yourself a Lift Today with Boost

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Telegram Channel
@booksmania

Use Words in Context

apologize	**coax**	**devote**	**refer**	**transport**
assemble	**concentrate**	**irritate**	**reject**	**reveal**
boost	**consult**	**manage**	**topple**	**weaken**

Directions Help the Wise Woman complete her journal entry. Write the correct vocabulary word on the blank to fill in each missing word.

Dear Journal,

Every day, I **(1)**_____ (*consult, boost, transport*) with people, giving them advice and helping them solve their problems. A few days ago, a farmer came to see me. He told me that the noise and activity in his small house **(2)**_____ (*apologized, devoted, irritated*) him. He could not **(3)**_____ (*assemble, reject, concentrate*) or focus on his chores. As a result, he could not **(4)**_____ (*manage, coax, topple*) to get much done. He needed to **(5)**_____ (*devote, weaken, consult*) more time to his work and spend less effort trying to keep everyone quiet.

I had a plan to help him, but I did not **(6)**_____ (*refer, reveal, irritate*) its purpose to him. I **(7)**_____ (*coaxed, concentrated, managed*) him into bringing a horse and some cows into his house. I asked him in a pleasant way, because who would want all those noisy animals inside? Once all the animals were **(8)**_____ (*revealed, weakened, assembled*) or gathered inside, what a racket they made! I still laugh when I think about it. The animals ran around bumping into things. They **(9)**_____ (*irritated, managed, toppled*) the dishes and furniture. If the farmer thought he had trouble before, now he could see what real trouble was like.

Tomorrow, I will tell him to take the animals back outside. The house will seem so quiet. I think he will **(10)**_____ (*coax, boost, apologize*) to me, telling me he is sorry that he doubted my wisdom.

Make a Thank-You Card Using Verbs Imagine that you are the farmer. Write a thank-you card to the Wise Woman for her good advice. Tell her what your situation was like before and why it is better now. Use at least three of the vocabulary words. Use new verbs, too.

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Put Words Into Action

apologize	coax	devote	refer	transport
assemble	concentrate	irritate	reject	reveal
boost	consult	manage	topple	weaken

Directions Choose a vocabulary word to fit in each caption below and write it on the blank. Then in the box draw a picture for each caption or write a sentence that the farmer might say.

1.

Look at the farmer speak gently to the animals and _____ them into the house!

2.

The animals _____ in the kitchen in a big group.

3.

The mess and noise _____ the farmer's family and everyone gets annoyed.

4.

Uh, oh! The furniture will _____ down and fall on the floor!

5.

The farmer will _____ to the Wise Woman and say that he is sorry.

6.

The Wise Woman will _____ the secret behind her plan.

Write a Story Using Verbs Write a story telling about the adventures of another person who goes to the Wise Woman for advice. First, jot down the problem. Then list in order the steps the Wise Woman takes to solve the problem. Make sure your story has a beginning, a middle, and an end. Use at least five vocabulary words. Underline each vocabulary word.

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Review and Extend

apologize	**coax**	**devote**	**refer**	**transport**
assemble	**concentrate**	**irritate**	**reject**	**reveal**
boost	**consult**	**manage**	**topple**	**weaken**

Learn More!

The **ending** of a verb tells when something happens. In grammar, the time a verb shows is called the *tense*.

Present Tense *(happening now)*	**Past Tense** *(already happened)*	**Ongoing Action** *(still happening)*
add *-s*	add *-d* or *-ed*	add *-ing*
He talks.	He talked.	He is talking.

Directions Read each item below. First, use context clues to decide which verb to put in each blank. Then decide on the tense of the verb. Write the verb in the correct tense in the blank.

1. The fifth graders are really working hard and **spend most of their time** helping animals. They are _____ time to this activity.

2. This year, they are **focusing** on learning about farming. Today, they are _____ on farm animals and crops.

3. Yesterday, the principal **met** with farmers to learn about crops. He _____ with the farmers.

4. The principal has **arranged** to get farmers to come to school to talk with students. She _____ to get five speakers to come.

5. Holding this meeting at school is easier than **moving** five classes of students! This way the principal would not be _____ 120 students.

Use Verbs to Write Bumper Stickers Use vocabulary words to write slogans for bumper stickers. Use a separate piece of paper for each bumper sticker. Begin each slogan with a verb or the words *Do not*. For example: Concentrate harder! Do not irritate your friends!

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Check Your Mastery

Directions Read each sentence below. Choose the word that best fits in each blank. Write the word in the blank.

1. When you put together the pieces of a model car, bookcase, or table, you (*boost, transport, assemble*) _____ it.

2. If you have poison ivy and you scratch it, you will probably (*irritate, topple, manage*) _____ it.

3. When raccoons chew on a tree, they (*weaken, boost, reveal*) _____ the inner core and the tree falls down.

4. People who enjoy their hobbies often (*coax, devote, refer*) _____ a lot of time to them.

5. Because Raul was reading a good book, he did not (*reject, concentrate, consult*) _____ on the TV show.

Directions Circle the letter of the correct answer to each of the questions below.

6. Which of the following actions might make someone **apologize**?
   A. eating a salad
   B. walking to school
   C. stepping on someone's toes
   D. writing an A+ book report

7. Which of the following would be the easiest for you to **transport**?
   A. time **B.** food **C.** rain **D.** hope

8. Which of the following would most likely **topple**?
   A. the foundation of a house
   B. a tower of blocks
   C. money
   D. ducks

9. Whom would you most likely **consult** if you were ill?
   A. a doctor **B.** a teacher **C.** a lawyer **D.** an athlete

10. Which of the following would a banker **manage**?
    A. liberty **B.** animals **C.** bakery goods **D.** money

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